

Pasta

Made from flour and eggs, plus a little water or olive oil, pasta has always been a very important food in Italy. Now it is popular throughout the world because it can be cooked in so many different ways. Pasta is also a great source of energy for our bodies.

MAKING PASTA

Pasta is not complicated to make, but it can take a little while. You can make it by hand, or you can use a food mixer. A pasta machine can be used to roll the pasta dough out and cut it into strips, depending on the shape that you want. You can use different types of flour, such as plain, semolina, buckwheat, or wholemeal flour.



1 ADD THE EGGS TO THE FLOUR

Make a well in the centre of the flour and then add the eggs.



2 MIX THE EGGS AND FLOUR TOGETHER

Combine the eggs and flour to form a dough, using a little olive oil or water to keep it moist.

SHORT PASTA

These small shapes are good for eating with chunky vegetable sauces, or for baked dishes. Many of their names reflect their shape, such as *conchiglie*, which means "shells", or *ruote* meaning "wheels".



ORECCHIETTE



CONCHIGLIE



GNOCCHI



RUOTE



RADIATORI



TROTTOLE



CRESTE DI GALLO



MACARONI



GRAMIGNE



BUCKWHEAT FUSILLI



FUSILLI



STRIGOLI



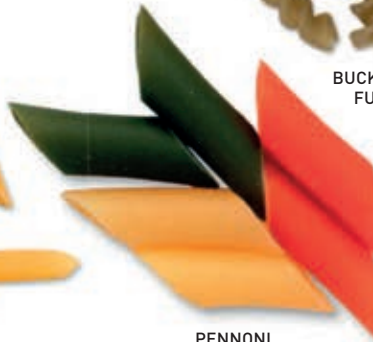
FARFALLE



DITALANI



PENNE RIGATE



PENNONI



RIGATONI



CAVATAPPI



CASARECCE



GARGANELLI

LONG PASTA

Long strands of pasta come in various thicknesses and can be round or flat. They are usually served with creamy sauces or tomato sauces that coat each strand of the pasta and add flavour.



TAGLIATELLE



MAFALDINE



LASAGNE



WHOLEWHEAT SPAGHETTI



TAGLIOLINI



CAPELLI D'ANGELO

TINY PASTA

Very small pasta shapes are often used in soups, or added to stews, because they are a quick and easy way to make the dishes more filling and serve more people.



RISONI



GRAMIGNA



ANELLI



ANELLINI



STELLINE



QUADRETTI



FILINI



ALFABETI